Report Writing 3/19/26

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HOUSEKEEPING

- EXAM GRADES HAVE BEEN UPLOADED TO BRIGHTSPACE
- C TO A RANGE
- EVERYONE GOT AN EXTRA POINT DUE TO QUESTION CONTROVERSY.
- SPRING BREAK IS NEXT WEEK…FINALLY!
- BRIEF DEBRIEFING AND INTRO TO REPORT WRITING.
- TEACHING TRW IN FALL 2026!

EXAM DEBRIEFING

- WHAT IS DICTION AND WHAT WAS THE CONTROVERSY?

SEMANTICS

- The branch of linguistics and logic concerned with meaning. There are a number of branches and subbranches of semantics, including **formal semantics**, which studies the logical aspects of meaning, such as sense, reference, implication, and logical form, **lexical semantics**, which studies word meanings and word relations, and **conceptual semantics**, which studies the cognitive structure of meaning.
- In short, subtleties of word usage.

CONNOTATION AND DENOTATION

- BOTH FALL UNDER THE SEMANTICS UMBRELLA

Semantic Shifts?

- A word’s usage, meaning, or level of appropriateness changes over time.
- Kid
- Awesome
- Guys

Words often Confused????????

- Coating vs Coding?
- Principle vs. Principle
- Stationary vs. Stationery
- Verses vs. Versus
- Creditability vs. Credibility
- Err vs Error
- Compliment vs Complement

Assuming there is still time...

- In-class writing prompts of the day:

1. What do you notice in the writing of others now?
2. What are you more mindful of with your writing/communication?
3. Other than the usual college kid activity, what are you looking forward to most over break?

COMMON COMMA CONCERNS

- Our Oxford Policy: He needs pens, paper, and staples.

COMMA SPLICE

- Illegal use of the comma!

Ted has an army jeep, he has a cheap insurance plan for it.

Parenthetical use of commas?

- You can use them instead of parentheses:

Tom, a Kentucky native, knows a thing or two about The Derby.

SEPARATING DEPENDENT AND INDEPENDENT CLAUSES

Examples:

As a result, there needs to be an new policy.

Before we started, let’s crack a few windows.

Lending the assist???

Check this out!

I want to go to Maine, but it is too far away.

*Trick question:

I need supplies but I am broke.

Moving into true Report Writing

- A bit more length and substance.
- More time to complete these projects.
- Same level of professionalism we established and maintained in here.
- Concise is nice.
- APA is going to play more of a roll? Role?
- More is at stake as far as the class is concerned and real world applications.

MARCH MADNESS: ROAD TO THE FINAL FOUR

Information Report/Plan	100 points
Proposal/Plan	125 points
Data Analysis	125 points
Presentation	100 points

Exam will be comprehensive and just one part.

Module 5: Informational and Analytical Reports

- Technical and business-related reports are important documents in the workplace. They address sophisticated needs and problems, proposing solutions and making recommendations to solve problems and improve businesses.

Your first report will be a short Informational Report

- There are two types of reports: informational and analytical. Informational reports rely totally on factual information and data. In such a report, the writer presents only the facts, derived from research, in a concise and objective format.

Whereas...

- Analytical reports rely on an interpretation of the facts to draw conclusions and/or make recommendations for action, One of the most widely-written and significant report in the work place is a data analysis.
- This type of report relies on the collection of factual data that is analyzed/ interpreted for meaning and decision making.

Common Bonds

- Both types of reports are based on objective, factual data, and require a clear statement of purpose and problem, in addition to identification of audience and knowledge of subject matter.

Common Bonds continued

- They often require primary and/or secondary research.
- Reports can be short (1-3 pages), intermediate (4-6 pages), or long (7+ pages).
- Longer report structures are the most formal, requiring front matter, which consists of a title page, letter or memo of transmittal, table of contents and list of figures Back matter includes references, glossaries (if needed) and appendices.

A report or proposal plan often helps writers identify purpose, problem and methodology, and organize content **before writing the report or proposal**

- In the category of routine informational reports are the following: Periodic, Feasibility, Progress, Operations, Trip/Travel, Test/ Lab, and Incident Reports.
- Among the most widely written analytical reports are Proposals and Recommendation Reports.
- All types may incorporate graphics for clarification and support.

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- Careful organization of reports is critical to understanding by any audience, from non-expert to expert.
- A report or proposal plan helps writers identify a problem, purpose and methodology, while an outline can help organize information before drafting the report.
- **Your first technical report will be an Informational Report. For this assignment, you will choose a topic in your field and write a 2-3 page report on a topic related to your field. Your audience will be a semi-technical (semi-expert) audience. Use at least two secondary sources.**
- **HOWEVER, before the actual report itself, you will submit a PLAN that is about 2 pages.**
- **This assignment is a 60/40 split.**
- **Put the plan in MEMO format and the REPORT in APA Report Format with title page.**

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QUESTIONS?

LOOKING AHEAD…

- Your second report will be a Proposal, followed by a Data Analysis.
- Read Chapter 15: Informal Reports (Informational)
- Read Chapter 16: Formal Reports (Analytical)
- Read Chapter 8: Designing User-Friendly Documents
- Review Chapter 7: Visual Design